

independents glumly decided it would be futile to bid and, in the end, I secured the lease for \$500—a bargain-basement price!

Soon thereafter, a corporation was formed to finance the drilling of a test well on the property. I, as a wildcatter with no capital of my own, received a modest 15-percent interest in the corporation. I assembled a crack drilling crew, and my men and I labored to erect the necessary wooden derrick and to rush the actual drilling operations. I remained on the site night and day until the drilling went into its final stages. Then, as I've related, I found it impossible to stand the nervous strain and fled to Tulsa, where my friend

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J. Carl Smith brought me the news that the well had come in.

The lease on the property was sold to a producing oil company two weeks after that, and I realized \$12,000 as my share of the profits. The amount was not very impressive when compared to the huge sums others were making, but it was enough to convince me that I should—

and would—remain in the oil business as a wildcatter.

My father and I had previously formed a partnership.

Under its terms he was to provide financing for any exploration and drilling I conducted and supervised for the partnership. In return, he would receive 70 percent of the profits, while I received the remaining 30 percent. After my first success, we incorporated the partnership and in May 1916 formed the Getty Oil Company, in which I received a 30-percent stock interest.

Many fanciful—and entirely erroneous—accounts of the business relationship between us have appeared in print.

Contrary to some published reports, my father did not set me up in business by giving me any outright cash gifts.

George F. Getty rejected any ideas that a successful man's son should be pampered or spoiled or given money as a gift after he was old enough to